

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 7

♥ 6

♦ K J 10 9

♣ J 9 8 4

♠ K 5 2

♥ A J 7 3

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 7 6



♠ 9 4 3

♥ K Q 10 9 5

♦ Q 4

♣ 10 5 2

♠ A Q 6

♥ 8 4 2

♦ 7 6 5 2

♣ K Q 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

signal and will play a different suit. So you throw out your ♥7 rather than the ♥3. Now East may think that West is encouraging him to continue, just what you want.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥K. West plays the ♥6.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 8

You just need one more winner and it could come from the ♦ suit if it happens to split 3-3. But you have another possibility. Suppose you let East hold the first trick and he decides to play another ♥? You would have two ♥ winners.

This isn't a true hold-up play although it does look like one. This play has the rather fancy name of Bath Coup, (named from Bath, England). Presumably East has led from ♥ K Q 10 9 5 and West has played his singleton ♥6. If East realizes that West has played his lowest card he will take that as a discouraging

Sometimes it works, sometimes it doesn't.

I sure hope that when you play this hand East falls for your Bath Coup.

Because if he doesn't you're going to have to end-play him.

Do you see how that might happen?

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 5
 ♥ J 10 9 8
 ♦ 9 6 4
 ♣ 10 3

♠ 9 6 2

♥ Q 5

♦ Q 10 5

♣ A Q 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 7 3

♥ K 6 4 3

♦ K 7 3 2

♣ 5 2

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A 7 2

♦ A J 8

♣ K J 8 6

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

 3NT by South
 Or not.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥J. You try dummy's ♥Q but East plays the ♥K.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=5 Total = 7

Things do not look good. You have only one ♥ stopper, the ♠ suit is wide open, and you have to have the ♦ finesse to get the two extra winners you need.

First problem: Do you hold up the ♥A or not?

No, don't hold up. If you do they might take 4 ♠ tricks immediately, then go back to ♥s. Since your only hope of making this contract is the ♦ finesse you should grab the ♥A, play 5 rounds of ♣s then finesse for the ♦K.

Remember: don't hold up when it gives the defenders a good opportunity to switch.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 10 8 2
♥ Q 10 4
♦ 9 7
♣ A 10 8 3

♠ A K 5

♥ A 7 2

♦ A Q 6 5

♣ K J 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 6 3

♥ K J 9 6 3

♦ 8 4 2

♣ Q 9

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 8 5

♦ K J 10 3

♣ 7 5 4 2

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦ tricks, then the ♠A, ♠Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when West plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

This is not a guess. If East has the ♣A he will get the lead and when he does he will set you with 2 more ♥ tricks. So you assume that West has the ♣A and play your ♣K.

This is a lesson about holding up, and if you had not held up twice in ♥s you would certainly have gone down.

But it's not enough to just be smart enough to hold up, you must also be able to figure out how to make the best plays later as well.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥6. West plays the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=4 ♣=0 Total = 8

Needing only one more winner you decide to hold up on the first ♥ and also the ♥ continuation. You take your ♥A on the third round, East having used the ♥3 to drive out your ♥A.

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦ tricks, then the ♠A, ♠Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when West plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

[showcards N:S7,C7,C5,C4 S:SK,CK,CJ,C6]